5. Maturation

Assembly of daughter virions follows the synthesis of viral nucleic acid and proteins. Virions assembly may take place in the host cell nucleus or cytoplasm. Herpes and adeno viruses are assembled in the **nucleus**, while picorna and pox viruses are assembled in the **cytoplasm**.

6. Release

In case of bacterial viruses, the release of progeny virions takes place by the lysis of the infected bacterium. However, in the case of **animal viruses**, release usually occurs **without cell lysis**. **Eclipse phase** is from the stage of penetration till the appearance of mature daughter virions. The virus cannot be demonstrated inside the host cell. The virus seems to disappear (Figure 10.2).

Viroids

Viriods are small, single stranded covalently closed circular RNA molecules existing as highly base paired rod like structure. The viroid depends on the host for replication. These are responsible for some of the transmissible plant diseases.

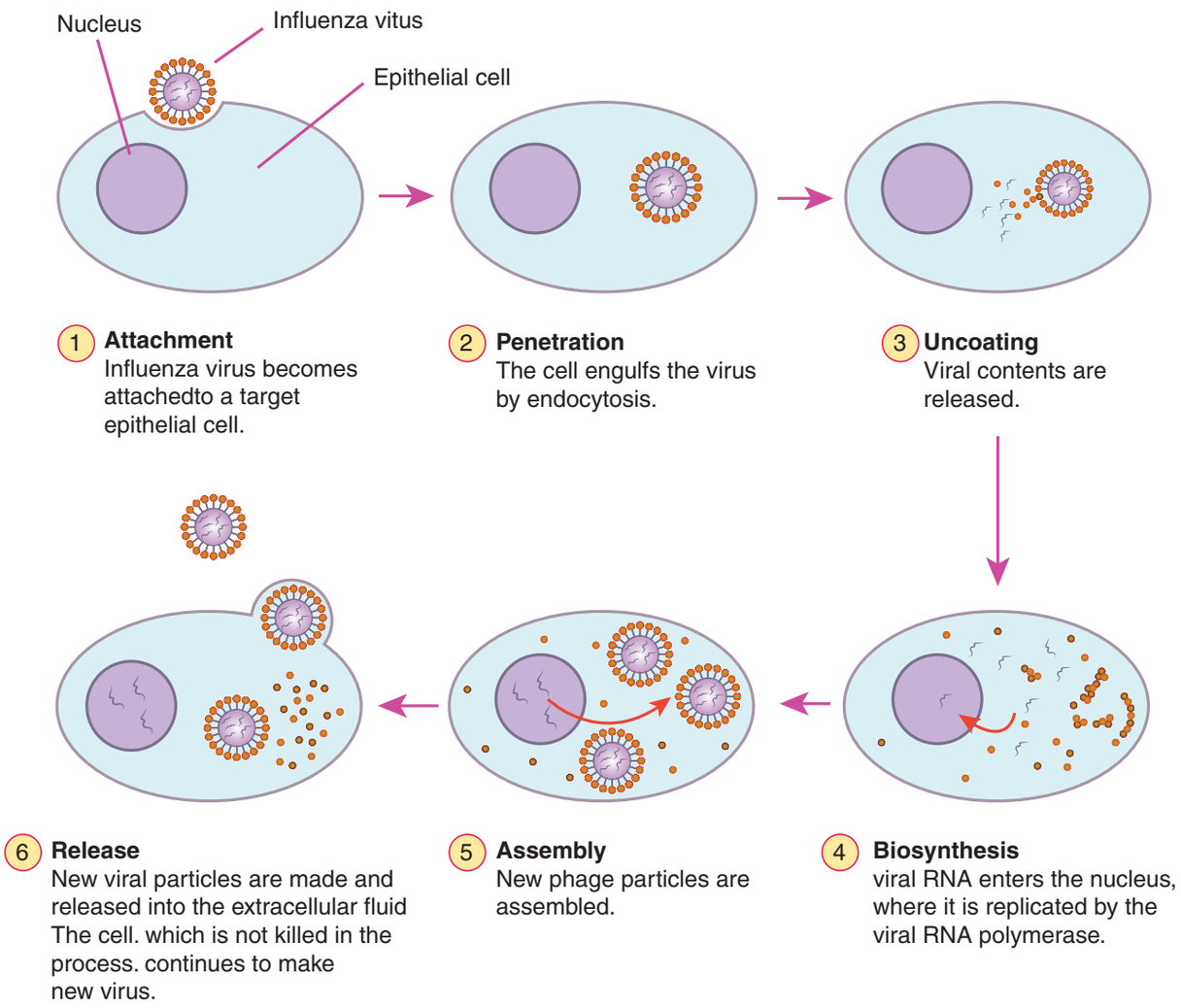


Figure 10.2: The Viral Life cycle

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